

BUYER'S REMORSE AND OTHER SIDE EFFECTS

I HAD SEVERAL CURIOUS REACTIONS TO BUYING MY STOCK, AND these I feel obligated to mention, on the off chance they are commonplace and should be brought out into the open. The first, as I've said, is this business of forgetting what I'd just bought. After any large purchase, such as a car or house, there's a customary period of remorse when the purchaser says to himself, *Oh, my God, what have I just bought?* What makes this case different is that the question was literal. While still in the phone booth on the side of the highway, I had to call back Ms. Garrett and ask her the name of the company so I could tell my wife at home.

This embarrassment could have been avoided if I'd written down the name in the first place. That I advise everyone to do. Luckily, Ms. Garrett was very nice about it, laughed, and said I'd bought Angstrom Technologies, symbol ATSI, a small scientific company in Kentucky. She also mentioned that my order already had been executed, and the price "we paid for it" was a bit higher than she'd anticipated— $1^{15}/_{16}$, or nearly two dollars a share. My total outlay was more than \$10,000, or \$10,143.15 to be exact. She asked me to put a check for that amount in the mail.

For several days after I'd sent the check, I continued to forget the name of the stock every time I tried to think of it. Since I'm known to have a good memory and since "angstrom" is a common symbol in science, I must have suffered a minor attack of the average investor's amnesia discussed earlier, brought on by the trauma of spending \$10,000 on the stock.

The afternoon I returned home, expecting to inform my wife of my \$10,000 interest in a small Kentucky company, I had a second curious reaction. Instead of recounting the event factually, I found